



Using a Customer Data System

The better you understand your customers or clients, the better you can meet their needs and encourage them to keep coming back. Customer relationship management (CRM) software can help you with this.

Understanding CRM systems

Your customers and clients will expect to be able to access your business online, whether to order goods, find special offers, book

appointments, or just ask questions. These interactions (known as “touchpoints”) can tell you a great deal about your customers—what they are interested in, what they buy and when, how often they

shop, and how much they spend. CRM software is widely available online to help you capture and analyze this data. You can use it to ensure your business offers your customers what they want, when

Using a CRM system

A CRM system works by collecting and analyzing data about customers’ or clients’ purchasing and communication history with your business. You can then use this data to better understand and target your customers and clients. Even a simple CRM system will help you in building customer relationships, improving customer service, and increasing the productivity and profitability of your business.

Gathering data from customers and clients

Existing and potential customers can interact with your CRM system in many different ways. Encourage this at every opportunity, so you understand their needs and expectations before they do business with you, and at every step along the journey. The more data the system collects, the more you can learn. Here are some ways to achieve this:



Create a website

Create an eye-catching website that draws users in and promotes your business. Use it to sell the brand and get people talking about you.



Reward customers

Offer incentives to customers for recommending your business. Reward repeat customers.



Improve customer experience

Impress customers and clients by exceeding expectations. Offer a personalized service, quality goods, unique packaging, and prompt delivery.



Use social media

Create a business profile and post relevant content. Aim to engage customers and clients in a conversation.



Promote products or services

Give regular discounts and special offers to attract attention to your business.



Follow-up complaints

Handle and resolve complaints properly. Where purchases require installation/service, follow up with customers and clients promptly, and provide detailed FAQs on your website.



Send regular e-communications

Email newsletters tailored to the interests of clients and customers. Write a blog and post videos online about your business.



Meet customers

Plan events, where you can engage with customers and clients. Invite people to sign up to your mailing list.